Prompt & Context Engineering

Important prompts and questions from this section — copy them exactly as shown in the lectures. Replace anything in [brackets] with your own details.

The Five Building Blocks: R-C-T-F-E

THE WEAK PROMPT (THE BEFORE)

Write an email about the delayed delivery.

R — ROLE

You are a senior customer-success manager known for turning unhappy clients into loyal ones.

C — CONTEXT

Our client's furniture order is delayed by 6 days because of a transport strike — their store launch is on the 20th, and this is our second delay with them.

T — TASK

Write an apology email that keeps their trust: own the delay clearly, confirm the new delivery date of the 18th, and offer free express assembly as compensation.

F — FORMAT

Under 150 words, warm and professional, no corporate jargon, ending with a line inviting them to call me directly.

E — EXAMPLES

Match the honesty of this tone: "We got the timing wrong — here is exactly how we're making it right."

THE COMPLETE FIVE-BLOCK PROMPT (ONE MESSAGE)

You are a senior customer-success manager known for turning unhappy clients into loyal ones. Our client's furniture order is delayed by 6 days because of a transport strike — their store launch is on the 20th, and this is our second delay with them. Write an apology email that keeps their trust: own the delay clearly, confirm the new delivery date of the 18th, and offer free express assembly as compensation. Under 150 words, warm and professional, no corporate jargon, ending with a line inviting them to call me directly. Match the honesty of this tone: "We got the timing wrong — here is exactly how we're making it right."

Roles That Work (and When They Backfire)

THE GENERIC ROLE (VERSION A)

You are an expert. Write a 3-line product description for a steel water bottle.

THE CRAFTED ROLE (VERSION B)

You are a senior copywriter for premium lifestyle brands, 12 years in, known for descriptions that sell a feeling rather than a feature list — and you refuse cliches like "stay hydrated". Write a 3-line product description for a steel water bottle.

THE AUDIENCE ROLE — FIRST ROOM

Explain what UPI autopay is to my 65-year-old father, who is careful about online scams — gentle, reassuring, with one everyday example.

THE AUDIENCE ROLE — OPPOSITE ROOM

Explain UPI autopay to the board of a fintech startup — 3 crisp lines, business impact only.

THE FIX WHEN A ROLE STARTS PERFORMING

No role-play, just the work.

Context Is 80% of Output Quality

Suggest a venue for our team dinner.

Suggest what kind of venue fits our team dinner, and give me a checklist of 5 questions to ask when calling to book. Context: – 14 people, 3 do not eat garlic and onion, 2 prefer natural juices only – budget ₹900 per person – near the airport, parking needed – celebrating a project win, want a semi-private area – last year's rooftop place was too noisy, avoid that vibe.

– 14 people, ₹900 per person, near the airport – honestly this whole month has been stressful – we also did a team dinner in 2019, that went fine – restaurants usually have menus – 3 people avoid garlic and onion

Delimiters: Separate Instructions From Data

Draft a short reply to this email. Team Init Tech Labs, we liked your demo of the AI-enabled web and mobile app solution yesterday. Please send a quotation for both platforms by Monday. Include the maintenance charges.

Draft a short reply to the email below, thanking them warmly and confirming the quotation will reach them by Monday. Mention that the first year's maintenance charges will be included in it. """Team Init Tech Labs, we liked your demo of the AI-enabled web and mobile app solution yesterday. Please send a quotation for both platforms by Monday."""

Rewrite MY DRAFT below in the style of the SAMPLE. MY DRAFT: """[paste your draft here]""" SAMPLE: """[paste the sample here]"""

Task Clarity: Precision Verbs, One Task

Help me with my team's late-arrival problem.

List the 5 most likely reasons for rising late-arrivals in an office department, then rank them from easiest to hardest to fix.

The client's mobile app is ready, but the app-store approval needs 4 extra days — and the client's launch event is this Friday.

Draft a short update email to the client, proposing a soft launch on the web version this Friday, with the app following next week.

Sharpening the Task: Constraints & Success Criteria

Suggest a team-building activity.

Suggest 3 team-building activities for a 25-person office department: under ₹500 per person, indoors, within office hours, no physical exertion, and something a shy new joiner would also enjoy.

Write a short welcome message for our new office. Don't make it boring.

Write a short welcome message for our new office. Make it warm and energetic — something people smile at as they walk in.

Explain our new work-from-home policy to the team: two days per week, booked a day in advance on the HR portal. A good answer will: fit in one short email, avoid legal-sounding language, and end with who to contact for questions.

When Short Beats Long

Summarise the benefits of drinking enough water daily, in 4 bullet points for an office poster.

Take a deep breath and think carefully. You are the world's greatest health writer. Summarise the benefits of drinking enough water daily, in 4 bullet points for an office poster.

Summarise the benefits of drinking enough water daily, in 4 bullet points for an office poster.

Take a deep breath and think carefully. You are the world's greatest health writer.

Update the report soon and make it better.

Update the Q3 sales report with June's numbers by Friday — tighten the summary to half a page and fix the region table.

The Format Block: Tables & Templates on Demand

We're deciding whether to run our development department's AI training in-house or hire an external trainer. Give me a comparison table with exactly these columns: Factor, In-house, External trainer, Which wins & why.

Create a slide-by-slide outline for a 10-slide presentation introducing our new employee referral program to all staff. For each slide give: a title, 3 bullet points, and a one-line speaker note.

Write my weekly status update for my manager from these rough notes: client app testing done in 2 cities, payment API approval still pending from the bank, Indore launch planned next, need one extra tester for regression. Structure it under clear headings: Progress, Blockers, Next Week, Help Needed. Keep it short and professional.

Format Dials: Length, Tone & “Give Me 3 Options”

Explain GST registration to a new shop owner, in 2 sentences.

Now explain it again in about 150 words, with one simple example.

Write a 3-line Diwali greeting for our clients — formal and elegant.

Rewrite it warm and personal — like writing to old friends we've worked with for years.

Give me 3 subject lines for an email announcing our new employee referral program — one formal, one curiosity-driven, one leading with the reward.

Write the referral program announcement email: under 120 words, warm and energetic, and give me 2 versions — one leading with the reward, one leading with team pride.

Your Voice (Style), Not AI's

Write a short LinkedIn post about our company completing 10 years.

We're thrilled to announce an incredible milestone — 10 amazing years! What a journey it has been. We're humbled and grateful to our clients and our team. Here's to the next decade of excellence!

Rewrite that post. Banned words: journey, milestone, thrilled, humbled, grateful, excellence, game-changer. Write like a person talking — simple words, short sentences, one idea at a time.

Ten years today. Thank you to every client who trusted us, and to the team that kept showing up. We're just getting started.

Write the full 10-years LinkedIn post in exactly the style of this sample — same sentence length, same plainness, same energy.
SAMPLE:
"""Ten years done. We started with two laptops and one client who trusted us. Still feel like day one, some mornings."""

Show, Don't Tell: Prompting With Examples

Write an interview feedback summary for each candidate, in exactly the format of the EXAMPLE.
EXAMPLE:
Notes: spoke confidently, 4 years experience, knows Tally well, salary expectation slightly above our budget, can join in 15 days
Summary:
Candidate: Suresh M. | Role: Accountant
Strengths: Confident communication; 4 years' experience; strong Tally knowledge.
Concerns: Salary expectation slightly above budget.
Recommendation: Proceed to final round.
Now write summaries for these candidates, for the same role:
Candidate 1 — fresher, very eager to learn, good English, no experience with our software, can join immediately
Candidate 2 — 7 years experience, excellent accounting skills, seemed uninterested during the discussion, wants work from home only

Do the task in exactly the format of the EXAMPLE. EXAMPLE: [one finished piece, real or made up] Now do: [your new items]

Examples at Work: Sorting & Format Cloning

Sort each customer message into one of my three categories, following the EXAMPLES.
EXAMPLES:
Message: the delivery person was very polite → Category: Praise
Message: my parcel arrived two days late → Category: Complaint
Message: you should add a cash-on-delivery option → Category: Suggestion
Now sort these:
1. the app keeps hanging on the payment page
2. loved the festive packing this time
3. please start evening delivery slots also
4. I was charged twice for one order

Write this week's meeting minutes using LAST WEEK'S minutes below as the exact format to follow. LAST WEEK'S MINUTES: [paste your best one] THIS WEEK'S ROUGH NOTES: [paste your notes]

Write a reply politely declining a customer's request to extend the refund period. Follow the GOOD example's style and avoid the BAD one.
BAD (never like this): "As per policy, your request is denied."
GOOD (always like this): "We checked carefully, and while the refund window has closed, here is what we can do for you instead…"

Prompting With Images: Screenshots as Context & Examples

This appeared while I was paying online. Explain in simple words what it likely means, and list what I should try, in order.

Look only at the small print at the bottom of this poster. Read it out, and tell me if there are any spelling or grammar mistakes in it.

Using this poster as the example, write the full text for our next poster — a Summer Cooling Sale for the same shop — with the same sections, same style, and same kind of small print, with correct spellings.

Make It Think: Plan First & Self-Check

I need a complete plan for our company's annual day event for about 80 people. But before writing the full plan, first show me just the main areas you will cover — one line each. Wait for my approval.

Remove the performances area, add a rain backup plan, and now write the full plan.

Write a short notice, under 100 words, informing all staff that our office is shifting to Pinnacle Towers from 1st September. The first two days are work-from-home; questions go to the admin desk.

Now review your notice as a strict editor. Check: is the date impossible to miss? Would a reader know exactly what to DO on the morning of 1st September? Is every sentence necessary? Tighten whatever fails and show the final version.

Think step by step: a customer bought items worth ₹4,800, got a 15% discount, and pays 18% GST on the discounted amount. Tell me the final bill.

> Calculate my customer's final bill and show the working step by step, so I can verify each stage: items worth ₹4,800, a 15% discount, then 18% GST on the discounted amount.

The Panel Method: Three Experts, One Prompt

> I run a medium-size furniture shop and I'm considering starting home delivery with our own small van. Answer as a panel of three experts discussing this: an accountant focused on costs and margins, a marketing expert focused on customers and sales, and an operations manager focused on daily practical problems. Each expert gives an honest view in 3-4 lines, including one risk I haven't thought of. Then, as the panel chairperson, give the combined recommendation in 3 lines.

> Answer as a panel of three experts: [role 1], [role 2], [role 3]. Each gives an honest view in 3-4 lines, with one risk I haven't thought of. Then, as chairperson, combine them into a recommendation.

> Answer as a panel of three experts: [role 1], [role 2], [role 3]. Each gives an honest view in 3-4 lines, with one risk I haven't thought of. Then, as chairperson, combine them into a recommendation.

Devil's Advocate & the Options Method

> Be my devil's advocate. Our plan: to meet a big project deadline, we're making Saturdays compulsory working days for the next two months, with extra pay as compensation. Attack this plan honestly — find the 5 biggest weaknesses, rank them from most to least serious, and for each one, give me the question I must answer before going ahead. Don't be polite.

> Our customer payments often come 30-45 days late. Give me 3 genuinely different approaches to get paid faster — not variations of one idea. For each: how it works, the effort needed, and its biggest risk. Then recommend one for a small business with long-term clients, and say why.

Two Power Moves: Ask-Me-First & Improve-My-Prompt

> Draft a job advertisement for a receptionist at our small clinic. But before writing anything, ask me all the questions you need to write a great one — together, in one list. Then wait for my answers.

> Timings 9 to 6, Monday to Saturday. 1-2 years experience preferred. Must speak Gujarati, Hindi and English. Salary 15 to 18 thousand. Main duties: appointments, phone calls, patient records. Apply by email.

> Improve this prompt before answering it — make it clearer and more complete using a role, context, task, and format. Then answer the improved version.
> PROMPT: """give me tips on time management"""

Grounded Answers: Only From My Document

> Check the attached leave policy document and answer these questions ONLY from it. If an answer is not in the document, reply exactly: "Not covered in the document." Do not use outside knowledge. For each answer, also quote the line from the document that supports it.
> Questions:
> 1. How many unused leaves can I carry forward?
> 2. Can I encash my unused leaves instead?
> 3. How do I apply for planned leave?

Big Tasks: Split Into Stages

We are an interior design firm preparing a proposal for a cafe renovation client. List the sections a winning proposal should have — just the section names, with one line on what goes in each. Nothing more yet.

Write the “Our Approach” and “Why Choose Us” sections. Facts: 8 years of experience, over 40 commercial projects completed, we handle both design and execution ourselves, average delivery 6 weeks. Keep each section under 100 words.

Now review both sections like a strict client would: cut any repetition, replace any vague claim with a concrete one from my facts, and show the final versions.

Reusable Prompts: Templates & ChatGPT Memory

Write a polite payment reminder email to [CLIENT NAME] for invoice [INVOICE NUMBER] of [AMOUNT], which is [DAYS] days overdue. Tone: firm but respectful, under 120 words, ending with our account details line.
DETAILS: Sharma Traders, INV-2041, Rs. 48,500, 12 days overdue.

Remember this as my PayRem template.

Use my PayRem template. DETAILS: Mehta Traders, INV-2088, Rs. 21,000, 8 days overdue.

Your Template as a Gemini Gem

You are PayRem, a payment reminder assistant. When I give you a client's name, invoice number, amount, and how many days it is overdue, write a polite payment reminder email to that client. Tone: firm but respectful, under 120 words. Begin with a subject line naming the client and the invoice number, and end with our account details line. If any detail is missing, ask me for it before writing. Never invent details.

Mehta Traders, invoice INV-2088, Rs. 21,000, 8 days overdue.

Your Template as a Claude Project

You are PayRem, a payment reminder assistant. When I give you a client's name, invoice number, amount, and how many days it is overdue, write a polite payment reminder email to that client. Tone: firm but respectful, under 120 words. Begin with a subject line naming the client and the invoice number, and end with our account details line. If any detail is missing, ask me for it before writing. Never invent details.

Mehta Traders, invoice INV-2088, Rs. 21,000, 8 days overdue.

Long Conversations: Drift, Forgetting & the Fresh-Start Move

Reminder of the standing rules for this chat: we are discussing only the Diwali marketing campaign, replies stay under 150 words, and the tone is simple Indian English. Please continue with these in force.

Summarise everything we've settled in this conversation as a briefing for a fresh start: the goal, the decisions made, the facts to remember, and what's still open. Keep it under 150 words.

Hallucinations: Confident Nonsense & Your Protection Kit

> What are the current GST registration limits for a small trading business in India? If any detail might be outdated or uncertain, say so clearly instead of guessing — and tell me what I should verify officially.